



# Inequality — Free Sample

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## INEQUALITY

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# HOW TO PLAY: INEQUALITY

*Fill the grid respecting the greater-than/less-than signs.*

4 puzzles · one per page · every solution printed

## RULES

1. Fill each row and column with digits 1 through N exactly once.
2. Inequality signs (< and >) between cells must be satisfied.
3. The pointed end of < or > always faces the smaller number.
4. Not all cell pairs have a sign — those are unconstrained.

|        |        |          |          |
|--------|--------|----------|----------|
| 3<br>v | 4<br>v | > 1<br>v | < 2      |
| 1      | 3<br>v | > 2<br>v | <        |
|        |        |          | > 3<br>v |
|        | ^      | 3        | 1        |

*Three cells are already worked out - the rest are yours.*

### PRO TIP

Cells involved in chains of inequalities (e.g.,  $A < B < C < D$ ) tell you the exact order. In a 4x4 grid,  $A < B < C < D$  means  $A=1$ ,  $B=2$ ,  $C=3$ ,  $D=4$ .

## COMMON MISTAKES

- Placing a digit that satisfies row/column but violates an adjacent inequality sign.
- Ignoring transitive chains — if  $A < B$  and  $B < C$ , then  $A$  must be less than  $C$ .

PUZZLE #1

Easy

|   |   |   |   |   |
|---|---|---|---|---|
|   |   |   |   |   |
|   | > | < | < | 4 |
| ^ |   | ^ | v | v |
| 4 | > | 2 | > | < |
| v |   | ^ | ^ | v |
|   | < |   | > | 2 |
| v |   | v | ^ | ^ |
|   | < | < | 4 | > |
|   |   |   |   | 2 |

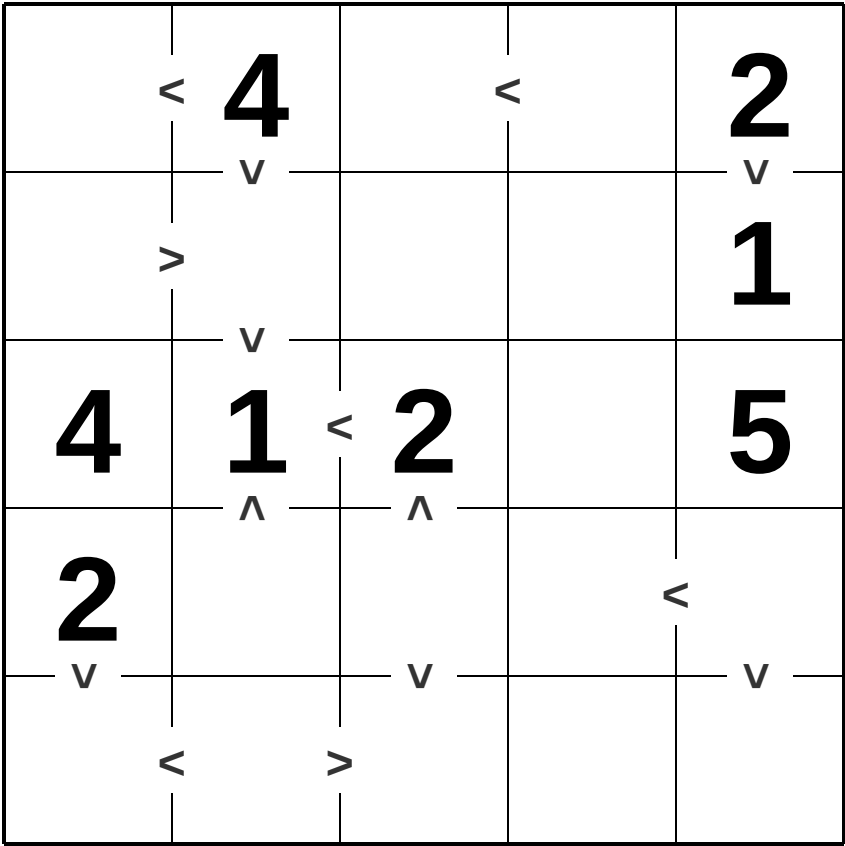
PUZZLE #2

Easy

|   |   |   |   |   |   |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
|   |   | 2 |   | > | 1 |
| v |   | ^ |   |   | ^ |
|   | < |   |   | 1 | < |
| ^ |   |   |   |   |   |
| 3 | > |   | < | < | 4 |
|   |   | ^ |   |   |   |
|   |   | 3 |   | 4 | > |
|   |   |   |   |   |   |

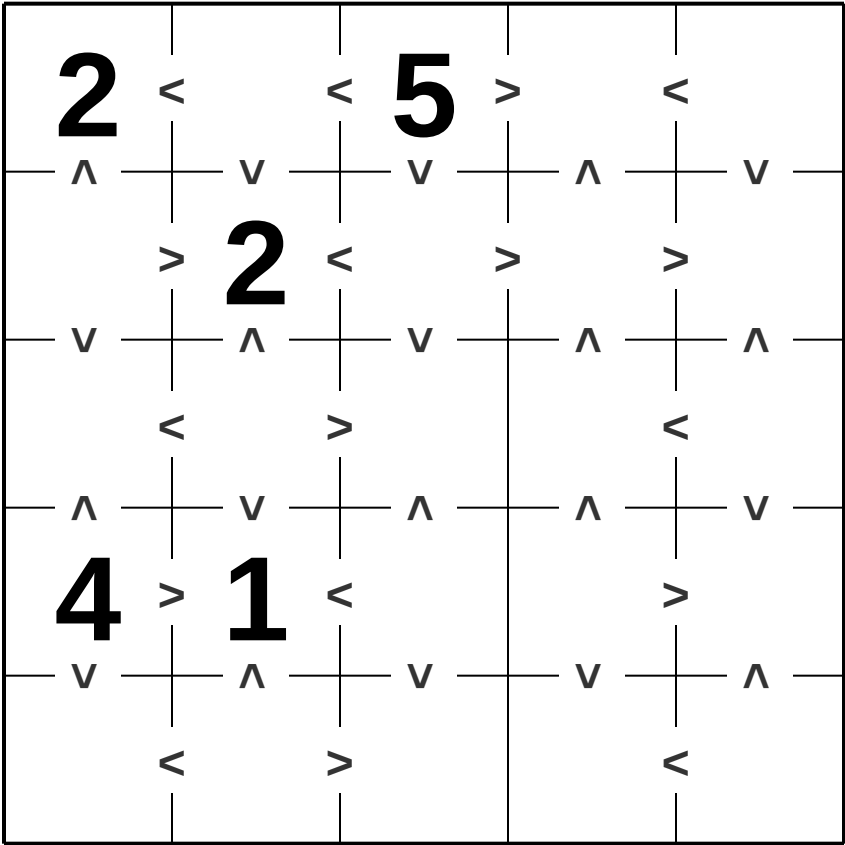
PUZZLE #3

Medium



PUZZLE #4

Hard





# **ANSWERS**

Check Your Mastery!

#1

|          |          |          |          |
|----------|----------|----------|----------|
| <b>2</b> | <b>1</b> | <b>3</b> | <b>4</b> |
| <b>4</b> | <b>2</b> | <b>1</b> | <b>3</b> |
| <b>3</b> | <b>4</b> | <b>2</b> | <b>1</b> |
| <b>1</b> | <b>3</b> | <b>4</b> | <b>2</b> |

#2

|          |          |          |          |
|----------|----------|----------|----------|
| <b>4</b> | <b>2</b> | <b>3</b> | <b>1</b> |
| <b>2</b> | <b>4</b> | <b>1</b> | <b>3</b> |
| <b>3</b> | <b>1</b> | <b>2</b> | <b>4</b> |
| <b>1</b> | <b>3</b> | <b>4</b> | <b>2</b> |

#3

|          |          |          |          |          |
|----------|----------|----------|----------|----------|
| <b>3</b> | <b>4</b> | <b>1</b> | <b>5</b> | <b>2</b> |
| <b>5</b> | <b>2</b> | <b>3</b> | <b>4</b> | <b>1</b> |
| <b>4</b> | <b>1</b> | <b>2</b> | <b>3</b> | <b>5</b> |
| <b>2</b> | <b>3</b> | <b>5</b> | <b>1</b> | <b>4</b> |
| <b>1</b> | <b>5</b> | <b>4</b> | <b>2</b> | <b>3</b> |

#4

|          |          |          |          |          |
|----------|----------|----------|----------|----------|
| <b>2</b> | <b>4</b> | <b>5</b> | <b>1</b> | <b>3</b> |
| <b>5</b> | <b>2</b> | <b>4</b> | <b>3</b> | <b>1</b> |
| <b>1</b> | <b>3</b> | <b>2</b> | <b>4</b> | <b>5</b> |
| <b>4</b> | <b>1</b> | <b>3</b> | <b>5</b> | <b>2</b> |
| <b>3</b> | <b>5</b> | <b>1</b> | <b>2</b> | <b>4</b> |



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